Title page (not for review)

Stagnation before exit: performance progression and retention in youth track and field

Running head: Progression and retention in youth athletics

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Ethics. The study is not medical or health research under Norway's Health Research Act and did not require approval by a Regional Committee for Medical and Health Research Ethics. Sikt (the Norwegian Agency for Shared Services in Education and Research) confirmed that the use of the data raises no data-protection concerns [reference number and date to be inserted]. No participants were contacted; the data are public competition results.

Related work by the author. Three earlier studies of the same registry are cited in the manuscript (one published, one in press, one under review). The present manuscript reports a different exposure, a different sample and pre-specified hypotheses that none of them tested; there is no overlap in results.